Finally, Nigel was firmly implanted in his aisle seat on the British Airways Boeing 787. It had been a very long day with multiple flights from a place he could not talk about to Miami to here...Dulles... only to wait some more.

As the words "long day" circulated in his brain Nigel floated off to thoughts of one of his favorite movies "The Longest Day" starring, among others, John Wayne and Sean Connery. He had actually visited the D Day beaches in some years past and purchased a "clicker" as a souvenir. Nigel floated further off to wonder whether he still had that "clicker" and if so where it was among his possessions. He used to keep it in his desk drawer and would often "click" it as a nervous habit.

Nigel abruptly cleared all the "Longest Day" thoughts and returned to the present.

He took a quick look at his watch and saw that it was going on 9:00 PM. A crew member had announced a new flight time of 9:00 PM. The flight had originally been scheduled to depart at 7:20 PM.

Having reset his brain to the current day Nigel took some time to take in his surroundings. It was quickly becoming clear that this flight was going to be full. Probably as a result of so many other flights being cancelled.

Whether he was on a plane, in a restaurant, or sitting on a park bench Nigel routinely "profiled" all the people around him. And so he began the process tonight on the plane. He knew it was integral to his profession but Nigel did it even when "off duty". It was a habit he could not break.

He didn't know exactly how many people could fit on a Boing 787 but it had to be several hundred. Nigel first did what he called a "macro scan" of his passenger

mates. This scan resulted in basic groupings...men, women, couples, singles, tourists/travelers, business people, and any other groupings like students.

The first scan did not reveal anything special and no one jumped out as being "interesting" or warranting a second look. Nigel initially thus concluded his travel mates for tonight were an average mix one would find on any such international flight.

Having completed the task of an initial scan Nigel's thoughts returned once more to another time and another place but not WWII movies this time. Instead his thoughts returned to the Caribbean Island he had just left this morning. It was the site of his most recent assignment. As an MI6 special ops member Nigel was prohibited from sharing any details of the operation. But, given a military coup had occurred on only one such island recently it wasn't that hard to figure out where Nigel had been in recent weeks.

There might, in history, been at least one bloodless coup but this one certainly wasn't it. Nigel had been involved in many such "disputes" in his twenty plus years being an MI6 operative. He had fought for both sides, but always secretly, and that was the case this time. Nigel had seen blood and so was the case this time as well.

In those twenty years Nigel had been in numerous "close calls" but nothing as close as this. At forty-four Nigel had started to think about how much longer he wanted to continue with his current job and similarly how much longer his luck might run out. Nigel had witnessed first hand the result of past mate's luck running out and quite frankly he didn't want it to happen to him. Nigel was pretty sure there was the potential for an MI6 afterlife. His body was starting to show the signs of the wear and tear.

He was very much looking forward to this vacation in England and to reacquainting with extended family members who he had not seen for some time and more importantly spending time away from the job to sort out his future. Nigel was bone tired and was in need of a large dose of quiet time at home.

In addition to his human family, Nigel was eager to spend more time with Booger. Booger was the three month old orange tabby kitten that had adopted Nigel (as opposed to the other way around) just before he left for the Caribbean assignment. He had never been around a cat before.

Nigel had been jogging in the park near his flat when this small orange ball of fur literally leapt out of the bushes and on to his pants leg. Nigel was amazed about how quickly the two became attached to each other. Why Booger? Nigel had a close mate in training with that nickname years ago. The two just seemed to have a similar personality.

As the plane reached cruising altitude and the cabin became quiet Nigel's brain quieted down as well and he slipped off into a well deserved deep sleep.